

Someone's Barbie

A Narrative Game of Consciousness, Control, and Belonging

Concept

Someone's Barbie is a third-person narrative game set in Kathmandu, Nepal, following a teenage girl named Sneha through school, family life, friendships, and the quiet moments in between.

The game begins as a story about a girl. It becomes a story about who is telling it.

Structured in three acts, Someone's Barbie explores the relationship between control and identity, what it means to be directed, and what it means to finally move on your own terms. The central mechanic evolves across the game in ways that mirror Sneha's growing self-awareness, making the player's experience of the game inseparable from its philosophical theme.

Personal Origin

This project began with a childhood memory , playing with Barbie dolls in Kathmandu, inventing their lives, scripting their joys and sadnesses. And the simultaneous, wordless feeling that I too was being played. That my life had a script I had not written.

Years later, through an engagement with ideas of consciousness and awareness, the understanding that we are not our thoughts but the observer behind them, I recognized what I had sensed as a child. Someone's Barbie is built from the space between those two realizations.

Target Audience

Players aged 16 and above drawn to introspective narrative games. players who have engaged with What Remains of Edith Finch, The Beginner's Guide, Undertale, or Disco Elysium. The game is rooted in a specifically Nepali and South Asian cultural context, but its philosophical core speaks to anyone who has ever asked, quietly: *is this me, or is this just what I was given?*

Platform

PC (Windows/Mac) via itch.io and Steam.

Status

Concept development stage. Planned as a central research and development project during MA studies.